

Salary Management System — Requirements Document

1. Goal

Build a web-based salary management system for ACME's HR team to replace spreadsheet-based salary management for approximately 10,000 employees across multiple countries.

The system should enable authorized users to manage salary information, maintain salary history, generate pay-slips, and answer business questions about compensation.

2. Primary User

HR Manager — responsible for managing employee and salary information and gaining insights into organizational compensation. (Discussion Needed: Currently, we plan to use simple RBAC with predefined roles instead of complex role-based permissions. Please confirm if this approach is acceptable.)

Employee - view their own salary information and generate/view their own pay-slips.

3. MVP Scope

Employee Directory

- View a paginated list of employees.
- Search employees by relevant attributes such as name and employee ID.
- Filter employees by country, department, designation, and other relevant attributes.
- View employee and current compensation details.

Salary Management

- Create, view, and update salary information.
- Although employees are across multiple countries, the system will **store and display all salaries in INR**. (Discussion Required: do we need to support currency conversion or different default currency in platform?)
- Support relevant salary attributes such as compensation amount (base, bonus, incentives, etc..), effective date and last updated date.
- Maintain salary history so previous salary records are not lost when compensation changes.

AI Salary Q&A Chat

For "system should answer questions about how the org pays people" - Provide a natural-language interface for HR managers to ask questions about compensation data. (Discussion Needed: Please confirm if this scope is correct or if any changes are required.)

Examples:

- "What is the average salary of engineers in India?"
- "Which department has the highest average salary?"

The AI functionality should generate answers based on the application's salary data while maintaining correctness and appropriate access controls.

Bulk CSV Import

- Import employee/salary data through CSV.
- Validate imported data and provide meaningful validation errors.
- Support the initial dataset of approximately 10,000 employees.

Role-Based Access Control

- Implement authentication and authorization.
- Define permissions based on user roles.
- Ensure salary information and management operations are accessible only to authorized users.

Pay Slip Generation

- HR Manager can generate and view pay slips for employees.
- Employee can generate and view their own pay slips.
- Generate pay slips using salary information available in the system.

4. Non-Functional Requirements

- Support approximately 10,000 employees with responsive search, filtering, and pagination.
- Relational database with appropriate indexing and data integrity constraints.
- Meaningful unit/integration tests covering core business logic.
- Secure handling of salary information and authorization checks.
- AI-generated answers should be grounded in application data rather than unsupported assumptions.

5. Post-MVP Scope

The following features are intentionally deferred to keep the MVP focused while leaving room for future evolution:

- **Detailed dashboard analytics:** advanced visualizations, trends, salary distributions, and deeper compensation insights.
- **Audit trails:** detailed tracking of who changed salary/employee information, previous values, new values, and timestamps.

6. Explicitly Out of Scope

To keep the assessment focused on salary management, the system will not include:

- Attendance & Regularization Management
- Recruitment/onboarding workflows
- Performance management

These are separate HR/payroll domains and are not required to demonstrate the core problem being solved.

7. Success Criteria

- HR Managers can find employees and create/update salary information while retaining salary history.
- Authorized users can ask compensation questions in natural language and receive data-grounded answers.
- HR Managers and Employees can access pay-slips according to their roles.
- The system can efficiently manage and exchange salary data for approximately 10,000 employees.